

BAND OF ONE · VERSION 1.0 · SEPTEMBER 2026

Brand Guidelines

Identity, voice, color, type, logo and packaging for both Band of One businesses.



Working name, pending owner approval

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Welcome to the brand

Band of One is one brand shared by two businesses:

1. **Digital products:** guides, templates and prompt libraries sold on Gumroad.
2. **Content:** a website, newsletter and social channels that teach the same audience for free.

These guidelines keep everything we publish recognizably ours: products, articles, videos and emails. They are written for you *and* for any AI assistant producing content for the brand. Paste the relevant section into your prompt when you generate new material.

STATUS

"Band of One" is a **working name** pending your approval and a trademark check. All files are built so the name can be swapped: change `Build_Tools/brand.py` and re-run the generators.

Brand foundation

Who we serve

People who run a **service business on their own**: freelance designers, writers, developers, marketers, consultants, coaches, virtual assistants, bookkeepers and photographers. They are good at their craft and tired of the admin that surrounds it.

The problem we solve

A business of one has to be the salesperson, project manager, accountant and marketer at once. Admin eats the week, invoices get paid late, and every new AI tool promises to fix it while adding another subscription.

What we promise

Small, specific, tested systems for the admin side of a one-person business. Fewer prompts, better outcomes, and no new subscription required.

Positioning statement

For people who run a service business on their own, Band of One is the practical, no-hype guide to handling client admin with AI and a few simple systems. Unlike AI-tool listicles and 10,000-prompt bundles, we give you complete workflows, with templates you can copy, and we say plainly what AI should not do.

Unique value proposition (short forms)

- **Primary:** Practical AI systems for businesses of one.
- **Benefit-led:** Spend less of your week on admin, without buying another tool.
- **Proof-led:** Real workflows, working templates, honest tool notes.

Personality

We are	We are not
Calm and practical	Hype-driven ("10x your income!")
Specific: real examples, real numbers with sources	Vague: "leverage AI to transform your business"
Honest about limits	Pretending AI can run your business for you
Warm and peer-to-peer	Corporate or preachy
Tool-agnostic	Tied to one app or one AI vendor

Voice and tone

How we write

1. **Lead with the job to be done.** "Send a payment reminder that gets a reply" beats "Invoice optimization strategies."
2. **Use plain words.** Short sentences. Explain any jargon once.
3. **Show, don't claim.** Include a template, an example or a screenshot instead of an adjective.
4. **Be honest about uncertainty.** Say "in our testing" or "according to [source, date]", or say we haven't tested it.
5. **Respect the reader's clients.** Never suggest tricks that deceive the people our readers serve.

Words we use and avoid

Use	Avoid
business of one, solo business, one-person business	solopreneur hustle, grindset
system, workflow, checklist, template	hack, secret, cheat code
draft with AI, then edit	let AI do it all
save time (with a specific example)	guaranteed results, passive income, make \$X
client, customer	"users" (unless software)

Claims policy (non-negotiable)

- No income or results guarantees. No fabricated testimonials, reviews, case studies or "we tested 50 tools" claims.
- Statistics always carry a source and date.
- Reviews state whether a tool was **tested hands-on** (and when) or **researched** from public information.
- Affiliate relationships are disclosed clearly and close to the link.

Color

Palette

Swatch	Name	HEX	RGB	Use for
	Ink	#1B2430	27, 36, 48	Body text, dark backgrounds
	Paper	#FBF8F3	251, 248, 243	Page backgrounds
	Band Teal (primary)	#0F6B64	15, 107, 100	Logo disc, links, primary buttons
	Deep Teal	#0A4A45	10, 74, 69	Headers, hover states, dark panels
	Mist	#E3F1EE	227, 241, 238	Tip boxes, light panels
	Signal Orange	#E8663D	232, 102, 61	The logo band, large graphic accents only
	Rust	#B8471F	184, 71, 31	Accent text, "Buy" buttons, warnings
	Butter	#F6C85F	246, 200, 95	Highlights, badges, reversed logo band
	Stone	#E4DED3	228, 222, 211	Borders and dividers
	Slate	#56606B	86, 96, 107	Secondary text, captions

Accessibility (WCAG 2.x contrast, measured)

Combination	Ratio	Passes
Ink on Paper	14.78:1	AAA text
Slate on Paper	6.04:1	AA text
Teal on Paper (links)	5.99:1	AA text
White on Teal (buttons)	6.35:1	AA text
White on Rust (buttons)	5.30:1	AA text
Ink on Butter (badges)	9.95:1	AAA text
White on Signal Orange	3.28:1	Large text / graphics only. Never use for body text or small buttons.

Proportion: about 60% Paper or white, 25% Ink, 10% Teal, 5% accents (Orange, Butter, Rust).

Typography

Role	Typeface	Weights	Fallback
Headlines, covers, logo	Fraunces (serif; SIL Open Font License)	600 SemiBold, 700 Bold; 400 Italic for emphasis	Georgia, serif
Body, UI, spreadsheets	Inter (sans-serif; SIL OFL)	400, 500, 600, 700	system-ui, Arial, sans-serif
Prompts, code, data	JetBrains Mono (monospace; SIL OFL)	400, 600	Consolas, monospace

All three are free Google Fonts under the SIL Open Font License, which allows commercial use and embedding in PDFs. Font files and licenses are in [02_Branding/fonts/](#).

Type scale (print): H1 27pt · H2 16.5pt · H3 12.6pt · body 10.6pt · captions 8.8pt. **Type scale (web):** H1 2.4rem · H2 1.6rem · H3 1.25rem · body 1.0625rem (17px) · line height 1.65.

Logo

The mark

A numeral **1** sits inside a teal disc, held by an open **band** of Signal Orange: one person, held together by good systems. The gap in the band keeps it light and forward-moving.

Files (in `02_Branding/logo/`)

File	Use
<code>band-of-one-horizontal.svg</code> / <code>.png</code>	Default logo for websites, documents and headers
<code>band-of-one-horizontal-reversed.svg</code> / <code>.png</code>	On Ink or dark photos
<code>band-of-one-stacked.svg</code> / <code>.png</code>	Square-ish spaces, covers, merch
<code>band-of-one-mark.svg</code> / <code>.png</code>	Avatars, favicons, stickers
<code>band-of-one-app-icon.svg</code> / <code>.png</code>	Social profile pictures, app icons
<code>favicon.svg</code> , <code>favicon-32.png</code> , <code>apple-touch-icon.png</code>	Website

Rules

- **Clear space:** keep empty space around the logo at least equal to the height of the "1".
- **Minimum size:** horizontal logo 120px wide on screen (1.1in in print); mark 20px.
- **Don't** stretch, recolor outside the palette, add shadows, put the full-color logo on busy photos, or rewrite the wordmark in another font.
- The italic *of* is always Teal (Butter on dark backgrounds).

Graphic language

- **The band:** a thick open ring in Signal Orange (or Butter on dark). Use it as a frame on covers and thumbnails, echoing the logo.
- **Discs:** solid Teal circles as background shapes.
- **Cards:** white or Mist rectangles with 8px corner radius and 1px Stone borders. Used for prompts, tips and checklists.
- **Imagery:** real interface screenshots, simple diagrams, and our own templates. **No stock photos posing as customers. No AI-generated "people" presented as real.**
- **Icons:** simple line icons, 2px stroke, Ink or Teal.

Product packaging system

Every product shares one visual system so the bundle feels like a set.

Element	Rule
Cover	Ink background, orange band + teal disc on the right, Fraunces title, product-type kicker in Butter, horizontal reversed logo bottom-left
Product color code	Guide = Teal disc · Workbook = Butter band · Prompt Library = Rust band (keeps them distinct in thumbnails)
File names	<code>Band0f0ne_<Product>_v1.0.<ext></code> (e.g., <code>Band0f0ne_Solo-Admin-Playbook_v1.0.pdf</code>)
Versioning	v1.0 at launch; minor fixes → v1.1; bigger updates → v2.0; changes logged in each product's <code>CHANGELOG.md</code>
Included in every ZIP	<code>START-HERE.pdf</code> , the product files, <code>LICENSE.txt</code> , <code>CHANGELOG.md</code>
Gumroad thumbnail	1:1 square (1600×1600) plus a 1280×720 cover image

Social profiles

Platform	Handle to reserve	Profile image	Banner
Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Pinterest, LinkedIn, X/Threads	@bandofonehq (check availability)	social/avatar-400.png	social/ folder (sized per platform)

Short bios live in Content_Automation_Business/02_Branding/Content_Brand_Strategy.md .

Decisions you need to approve

1. The working name **Band of One** and domain choice (see *Brand Name Options*).
2. The palette and logo (changeable in `Build_Tools/brand.py` + `make_logo.py`).
3. Handles to reserve.